



ERIN FORTUNA

MANAGER MAJOR EVENTS, ENGAGEMENT, PROTOCOL

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ABOUT

Boston-based conscientious, determined manager of major events, stakeholder engagement and protocol, with a proven record of delivering professional event management services within dynamic and deadline-driven environments.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SENIOR PROGRAM AND EVENTS OFFICER | PROGRAM MANAGER DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION, QUEENSLAND, AUSTRALIA

May 2018 – September 2020 | October 2011 – September 2016

The Department of Education is a ministerial department of the Queensland Government (Australia) and is responsible for the delivery and quality of world-class education services for Kindergarten to Year 12.

Key responsibilities

- Develop/deliver strategic consultancy services to promote a range of key departmental initiatives through event, communication, and marketing strategies.
- Manage major departmental programs and events, including managing critical aspects of state-wide performances, gala dinners and conferences, ensuring productions remain within budget and deadlines.
- Analyze complex communication needs for the Programs and Events Unit, internal and external clients and provide creative, strategic communications solutions and events advice.
- Liaise with the Minister's office for all media and event enquiries through the provision of advice on departmental procedures and processes and coordination of the department's business.

Key achievements

Management of annual project budgets of \$1.6million, including the contractual execution of \$800,000 in trade exhibition and sponsorship income.

Management of a 2-month proactive media campaign (Queensland Education Accord), obtaining 375 media reports with a circulation of 7.8 million and a complimentary space rate value of \$670,000.

Delivery of a state-wide consultation, encouraging schools, unions, parents, and students to have their say on the future of education. Delivery, in conjunction with, a two-day conference (involving every QLD Member of Parliament), lead to the creation of QLD's first Education Accord.

Development/delivery of the Biennial Principals' Conference – an exclusive two-day conference for 1600 delegates, including the successful management of 71 sponsors and trade exhibitors, 20 speakers and multiple social functions.

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

Development of strategic direction aligning to organizational objectives.

Building organizational capability through evaluation and continuous improvement.

Development and nurturing of critical networks and partnerships.

Strong communication and negotiation skills, with a bespoke stakeholder approach.

Personal/professional drive and resilience in high pressure environments.

Ability to lead and inspire teams through team development.

EDUCATION

Bachelor Fine Arts, Tech Prod
QUT Creative Industries
Major: Production/Event Mgt

Adv Diploma of Project Mgt
South Bank Institute of TAFE

Adv Diploma of Business Mgt
South Bank Institute of TAFE

Diploma of Marketing
North Coast Institute of TAFE

AWARDS

QUT, Faculty of Business
Personal achievement:
Vice Chancellor's Staff Award

"A creative thinker, coupled with her down to earth personality, Erin is an invaluable team member and an asset to any organization."

2018 COMMONWEALTH GAMES

The Gold Coast 2018 Commonwealth Games (GC2018) was an international multi-sport event which welcomed more than 6,600 athletes and team officials from 71 Commonwealth nations and territories.

GC2018 was the largest sporting event to be staged in Australia this decade, and featured the largest integrated sports program in Commonwealth Games history, comprising 18 sports and seven para-sports.

REFEREES

Melissa Price
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MANAGER | PROTOCOL AND GAMES FAMILY SERVICES EVENTS GOLD COAST 2018 COMMONWEALTH GAMES CORPORATION

September 2016 – May 2018

Delivery of protocol and events services to international dignitaries, sovereigns, world political leaders (Head of Commonwealth Representative, Prime Ministers, Presidents, Heads of State) and the Commonwealth Games Federation and Associations.

Key responsibilities

- Stakeholder engagement and operational management for diplomatic visits of national, international, and royal dignitaries – including His Royal Highness, The Prince of Wales.
- Responsible for the successful delivery of the GC2018 Games Family program. 3250 clients | 15 days | 19 venues.
- GC2018 secretariat management of the Commonwealth Games Federation.
- Expert advice in government and sovereign relations.
- GC2018 Protocol Coordination Centre – C3 planning for operations/reporting.
- Operational development of 19 Gold Coast 2018 venues
- Opening and Closing Ceremony event operations/ticketing for 3250 clients.
- Victory Ceremonies presenter program and the GC2018 Flag consultation.

Key achievements

Management (including HR, training, and operations) of 313 Protocol team members – 30 paid (direct reports) and 283 volunteers.

Delivery of more than 135 visits by dignitaries assigned police protection.

Mutually beneficial negotiations and engagement with more than 90 international stakeholders representing sporting bodies, associations, police agencies and governments.

Development of the GC2018 Victory Ceremonies program, including 580 medal and gift presentations.

Development and negotiation of 25 critical operational policies/procedures.

MANAGER - EVENTS AND SPONSORSHIP | THE BMD GROUP

November 2010 – November 2011 (1 year contract)

Develop and deliver the company's annual strategic events and sponsorship strategy, to enhance the company's national profile and differentiate the company's market position.

MAJOR EVENTS/ENGAGEMENT OFFICER | QLD UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY

August 2008 - November 2010

Manage and deliver high-profile major events and engagement activities to enhance QUT Faculty of Business' reputation within the professional market.

EVENT AND STAGE MANAGER

Freelance | 2003 - 2008

Delivery of major events: Australian Chamber Orchestra, Queensland Music Festival, Out of the Box Festival, World Beat Music Festival, Australian Chamber Orchestra Concerts, Ten Tenors, Band of the Irish Guard, Queensland Orchestra Concerts. Multiple five-day conferences, with independent budgets of \$1 million: each involving +1500 delegates, trade exhibition, gala dinners, breakouts, partner's programs and activity days.